

The Syntax of Adverbial Clauses in Persian

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Objectives:

In this talk I wish to explain the external and the internal syntax of Persian adverbial clauses as relative clauses. I will also show that the way is not much paved, that there are more questions than answers.

Embedded CPs in Persian:

Let's start with where the embedded CPs appear in Persian:

First, we have relative clauses that serve as modifiers in the nominal domain. Then, we have clausal complements that occupy argument positions (namely, the internal argument). They are assigned theta-roles. And finally, we have the so-called adverbial clauses that provide extra functional information about the main clause.

Relative Clauses: Ordinary relative clauses look like the examples in (1) and (2). We have the noun to be modified, then we have the indefinite marker, *-i*, also referred to as a relativizer, and then the embedded CP, the relative clause that starts with the complementizer *ke* 'that'.

(1) doxtær-i ke vijolon mi-zan-e
girl-REL that violin IMPFV-hit-3SG
'the girl who plays the violin'

(2) ketab-i ke xund-æm(-eʃ)
book-REL that read.PST-1SG(-3SG.ACC)
'the book that I read'

When the related noun is the object in the embedded CP as in (2), the gap may be pronounced as a clitic pronoun. This is not the case with subjects, as in (1).

Karimi, revisiting Kayne's analysis, proposes the structure in (3) for restrictive relative clauses in Persian. The pronominal inside the relative clause is coindexed with an operator and also with the head noun which is base-generated not in the embedded CP but in the specifier of higher DP. This higher DP is headed by the relativizer *-i*.

(3) [DP [DP (D) N]_i [D' -i [CP OP_i [C' ... pro_i]]]]
(Karimi 2001)

Karimi also deals with subcategorized complements in Persian complex DPs, as exemplified in (4). She proposes the structure in (5) for these constructions, an account very similar to the syntax of restrictive relative clauses, with the distinction that the head of the higher DP is null here; it is not occupied by *-i*.

- (4) ?in ?edde?ɑ ke hæme bimar-æn
 this claim that all ill-be.3PL
 ‘the claim that everybody is ill’

- (5) [DP [DP (D) N]_i [D' Ø [CP OP_i [C' ... pro_i]]]]
 (Karimi 2001)

Ayaka Sugawara and I have just started working on this issue. Based on Cinque’s (2020) unified analysis of relative clauses and Marcel den Dikken’s (2006) account of predicate inversion, we put forth the structure in (6) for Persian complex DPs. Here we have a predicate related to a CP via a relator head. The phrase goes under predicate inversion via a linker phrase which, in turn, is the complement of a D head. I will be back to this.

- (6) [DP [D' D [LP [PREDICATE] [L' L+R [RP [CP ...] [R' ~~R~~ [PREDICATE]]]]]]]
 (Ilkhanipour & Sugawara 2024)

Clausal Complements: After relative clauses, there comes clausal complements. A large group of predicates take clausal complements as their internal argument in Persian. I exemplify the English translation here: predicates of saying (say), propositional attitudes (believe), fiction predicates (dream), factives (regret), semifactives (understand), predicates of fearing (worry), desideratives (hope), causatives (cause), permissives (permit), modals (be able), achievement predicates (succeed), predicates of immediate perception (hear) and negative predicates (not) (Ilkhanipour 2016 based on Noonan 2007).

Here are some examples:

- (7) mi-dun-æn ke hazer-æn
 IMPFV-know-1SG that present-be.3PL
 ‘I know that they are present.’
- (8) mi-tærs-æn ke be-mir-æn
 IMPFV-fear-1SG that SBJV-die-3PL
 ‘I fear that they die.’
- (9) ?edʒaze dad-æn ke be-r-æn
 permission give.PST-1SG that SBJV-go-3PL
 ‘I permitted them to go.’

Based on Kayne (2008) and Aboh (2010), in the last chapter of my PhD thesis (Ilkhanipour 2016) I put forth the question of reanalysing complement clauses as relative clauses in Persian. Preliminary evidence for this claim comes from examples like (10) to (12) where the internal argument is spelled out as a DP which is modified by a relative clause. Interestingly, as can be seen in (12), the preverb of a complex predicate can change role to a direct object modified by the relative clause.

- (10) **?in-o** mi-dun-æn ke hazer-æn
 this-OM IMPFV-know-1SG that present-be.3PL

(11) ʔæz ʔin mi-tærs-æm ke be-mir-æn
 from this IMPFV-fear-1SG that SBJV-die-3PL

(12) ʔin ʔedʒazæ ro dad-æm ke be-r-æn
 this permission OM give.PST-1SG that SBJV-go-3PL

Adverbial Clauses: And finally, the so-called adverbial clauses that can be used to express and provide information about condition, reason, time, contrast, purpose and result. Here I focus on the first two and add some points on the temporal clauses. Conditionals are introduced with *ʔægær* ‘if’, causal clauses with *tʃon* ‘because’ and temporal clauses with *væqt-i* ‘when’. Examples (13) and (14) are two instances of adverbial clauses in Persian. The phrases in the brackets are considered as adverbial clauses. And, the underlined phrases are traditionally considered as complex conjunctives.

(13) [væqt-i ke did-æm-eʃun] sælam kærd-æm
 time-REL that see.PST-1SG-3PL.ACC hello do.PST-1SG
 ‘I said hello when I saw them.’

(14) [dær suræt-i ke be-bin-æm-eʃun] sælam mi-kon-æm
 in form-REL that SBJV-see-1SG-3PL.ACC hello IMPFV-do-1SG
 ‘I will say hello if I see them.’

In not a recent paper written in Persian, Alborzi Verki (2000) observes that the so-called adverbial clauses are indeed relative clauses that modify “a noun + a determiner” as in (13) or a “cliché PP” as in (14). He notes that the nominal itself can be an adverb and that the noun can be followed by *-i*, and thus we’re dealing with a restrictive relative clause. Fine observation, sound conclusion, but without any theoretical prelude, and consequently with no analysis or explanation!

After 25 years, now there is a paper again written in Persian published in Iran, by Valipour (2025). She provides some theoretical prelude with referring and building her description on Karimi 2001, Demirdache & Uribe-Etxebarria 2004 and Haegeman 2012. Some descriptive extension, although with some incorrect grammaticality judgements and some weak structural descriptions, still theoretically much better than Alborzi’s paper, but old conclusion with no novel theoretical implication! So here I attempt to deal with these shortcomings.

The External Syntax of Adverbial Clauses:

Following Ilkhanipour and Sugawara (2024), I take this structure and I’ll show how this can explain the external syntax of adverbial clauses in Persian.

$$[_{PP} [_{P'} P [_{DP} [_{D'} D [_{LP} [PREDICATEP] [_L L+R [_{RP} [_{CP} \dots] [_{R'} R [PREDICATEP]]]]]]]]]$$

I will talk about the Relator Phrase that Relates a predicate to a CP, the Linker Phrase that provides the space for predicate inversion, and the PP with its DP complement. I will discuss how these projections bring together different syntactic objects to form a complex adverbial phrase.

Let me start with the very left side of the structure, what is spelled out before the embedded CP.



Here, I want to show that Persian ‘if’ and ‘because’ are not heads of functional projections, but the specifiers of the related FPs. And I will discuss the predicative nature of these elements. I’ll argue that they can be regarded as weak nominals. To have a clearer picture, let’s see some examples. Conditional adverbials may appear before or after the main clause. They begin with *ʔægær* ‘if’ which is immediately followed by a CP. The complementizer *ke* can be unpronounced. And importantly, Kabiri (2014) proposes that Persian ‘if’ is base-generated as the head of a conditional phrase.

- (15) [ʔægær (ke) be-r-i] mi-bin-i-ʃ
 if that SBJV-go-2SG IMPFV-see-2SG-3SG.ACC
 ‘If you go, you will see her/him.’

- (16) mi-bin-i-ʃ [ʔægær (ke) be-r-i]
 IMPFV-see-2SG-3SG.ACC if that SBJV-go-2SG
 ‘You will see her/him if you go.’

With causal adverbials, again they may appear before or after the main clause. They begin with *tʃon* ‘because’ immediately followed by a CP. Again *ke* ‘that’ may be unpronounced. By analogy, *tʃon* might be considered as the head of a Reason Phrase.

- (17) [tʃon (ke) ræft-i] did-i-ʃ
 because that go.PST-2SG see.PST-2SG-3SG.ACC
 ‘Because you went, you saw her/him.’

- (18) did-i-ʃ [tʃon (ke) ræft-i]
 see.PST-2SG-3SG.ACC because that go.PST-2SG
 ‘You saw her/him because you went.’

Persian if can be replaced by the PP *be ʔin ʃært*, literally ‘to this condition’. So ‘if’ is in complementary distribution with a PP.

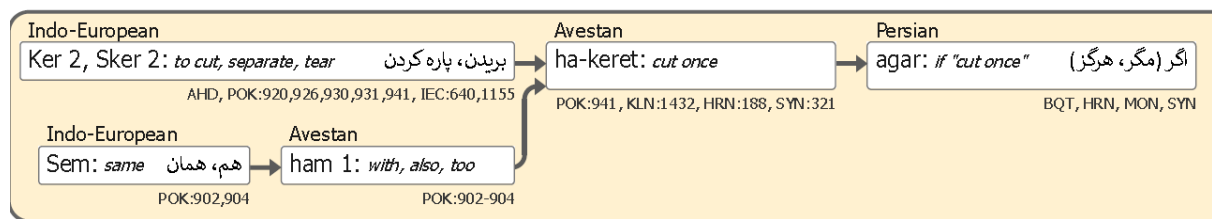
- (19) [be ʔin ʃært ke be-r-i] mi-bin-i-ʃ
 to this condition that SBJV-go-2SG IMPFV-see-2SG-3SG.ACC
 ‘If you go, you will see her/him.’

Persian ‘because’ can be replaced by a PP as well. The PP *be ʔin dæʔil*, literally ‘to this reason’ can replace *tʃon* ‘because’.

- (20) [be ʔin dæʔil ke ræft-i] did-i-ʃ
 to this reason that go.PST-2SG see.PST-2SG-3SG.ACC

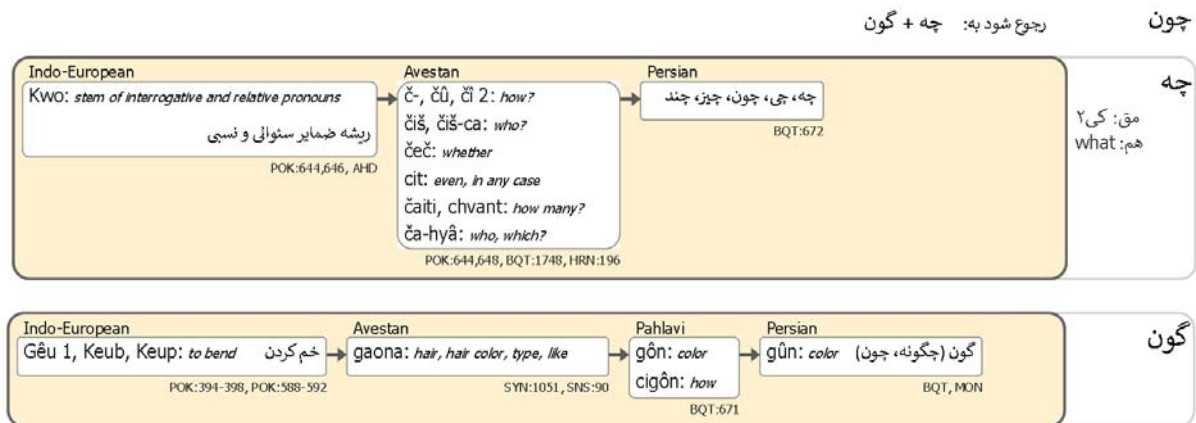
According to Chomsky (1995), heads are nonbranching. Heads are not phrases. They're not maximal projections. And we just saw that Persian 'if' and 'because' are in complementary distribution with some maximal projection. So I conclude that Persian 'if' and 'because' are not heads. Following Kayne (2016) and Cinque (2017), I believe that heads are silent and that these elements are base generated in the specifier position.

I just proposed that 'if' and 'because' are in complementary distribution with a PP. But the question is: what is the nature of the Predicate Phrase? Is it really prepositional? or do we have a phrase of some nominal or even hybrid nature which moves upward and the PP is a higher projection with a pronounced or unpronounced preposition? Let us see what evidence supports each. First, the etymology of *ʔægær* 'if' indicates that diachronically there is some prepositional element in this words as well as a nominalized verbal element.



(Nourai 2022)

With *tʃon* 'because', we can see a wh-element and a nominal element that comes from a verb.



(Nourai 2022)

Crucially, both *ʔægær* and *tʃon* inherit some predicative nominal element which justifies their base-generation in a PREDICATE phrase. Moreover, despite nominality, referentiality is lost in both. Neither *ʔægær* nor *tʃon* refer to entities, states or events although they enjoy the nominal feature. I use the term weak nominals for this property and I will make use of it to justify some of their behaviours with relative clauses. Another point is the hybrid nature of these elements, *ʔægær* inherits a prepositional element and *tʃon* a wh-element.

Another piece of evidence for the hybrid nature of *ʔægær* and *tʃon* comes from idiomatic expressions. *ʔægær* 'if' can be coordinated with *ʔemma* 'but' which is a conjunctive and then this combination appears as the complement of the preposition *ba* 'with'.

- (21) *ba* *ʔæmma-o-ʔægær* *ne-mi-tun-im* *kar* *kon-im*
 with but-and-if NEG-IMPV-can-1PL work SBJV-do-1PL
 ‘We can’t work with ifs and buts.’

A similar story for Persian because: *tʃon* (*tʃun*) is coordinated with ‘why’ and then the combination is the complement of the preposition *bi* ‘without’, as in (22).

- (22) *bi* *tʃun-o-tʃera* *ʔmæd-im*
 without because-and-why come.PST-1PL
 ‘We came without question.’

Another piece of evidence is from the negative form of ‘if’, *mægær*. Interestingly, after *mægær* ‘unless’ we can have the demonstrative *ʔin* ‘this’ and then the relative clause, as in (23). Persian ‘unless’ behaves like a preposition here.

- (23) *ne-mi-bin-i-ʃun* [*mægær* *ʔin* *ke* *ber-i*]
 NEG-IMPV-see-2SG-3PL.ACC NEG.if this that SBJV-go-2SG
 ‘You won’t see them unless you go.’

The word for ‘because’ in Persian is polysemous. Another meaning of *tʃon* is ‘like’, as exemplified in (24). Here again after *tʃon* we have a nominal phrase and *tʃon* behaves like a preposition.

- (24) *tʃon* *ruz* *roʃæn* *bud*
 like day bright be.PST.3SG
 ‘It was as clear as day.’

More evidence to investigate what is modified by the embedded CP comes from purpose clauses. Here we have the goal preposition *ta*, optionally followed by the demonstrative *ʔin* ‘this’ and then the relative clause.

- (25) *ʔumæd-æn* [*ta* (*ʔin*) (*ke*) *to* *ro* *be-bin-æn*]
 come.PST-3PL to this that you OM SBJV-see-3PL
 ‘They came to see you.’

And Temporal clauses: Here we have *væqt-i*, literally ‘time + the indefinite marker’, followed by the embedded CP. This ‘time + the indefinite marker’ is the Persian counterpart of English ‘when’ in temporal adverbials **only**, and NOT in main questions NOR in embedded questions. It can be replaced by the PP *dær ʔan væqt* ‘in that time’.

- (26) [*væqt-i* (*ke*) *ʔumæd-æn*] *to* *ro* *did-æn*
 time-REL that come.PST-3PL you OM see.PST-3PL
 ‘They saw you when they came.’

What we have found so far is that what precedes the embedded CP in adverbial clauses can be “overt P + a null nominal” as in purpose clauses, it can be “a null P + some overt nominal” as in temporal clauses, or it may be “a Predicate Phrase with hybrid behaviour” as in conditional and causal clauses. In all these cases, there is some nominal feature to provoke relativization and there is some prepositional cue to maintain uniformity.

Back to weak nominality of Persian ‘if’ and ‘because’, this property explains (i) where the complementizer *ke* ‘that’ can be unpronounced, (ii) where the presence of the relative clause is obligatory and (iii) where the relative clause can be separated from the nominal to which it is related.

As can be seen in (27) and (28), the complementizer can be unpronounced with *ʔægær* which is nominally weak, but it must be pronounced with a full nominal like *fært* ‘condition’.

(27) *ʔægær* (ke) be-r-i
if that SBJV-go-2SG

(28) be ʔin fært *(ke) be-r-i
to this condition that SBJV-go-2SG

The same is with causal clauses; with *tʃon* ‘because’ the complementizer can be phonetically null, but not with the nominal *dælil* ‘reason’.

(29) *tʃon* (ke) ræft-i
because that go.PST-2SG

(30) be ʔin dælil *(ke) ræft-i
to this reason that go.PST-2SG

Another issue is that with weak nominals, it is not possible to remove the relative clause altogether. In other words, weak nominals cannot stand on their own. With *ʔægær* ‘if’, the embedded CP must be present, while it is optional with the full nominal *fært* ‘condition’.

(31) *ʔægær* *(ke be-r-i) mi-bin-i-ʃ
if that SBJV-go-2SG IMPFV-see-2SG-3SG.ACC

(32) be ʔin fært (ke be-r-i) mi-bin-i-ʃ
to this condition that SBJV-go-2SG IMPFV-see-2SG-3SG.ACC

The same is true for causal clauses, as in (33) and (34).

(33) *tʃon* *(ke ræft-i) did-i-ʃ
because that go.PST-2SG see.PST-2SG-3SG.ACC

(34) be ʔin dælil (ke ræft-i) did-i-ʃ
to this reason that go.PST-2SG see.PST-2SG-3SG.ACC

Weak nominals cannot stand on their own. Thus, they are not separable from the embedded CP whereas full nominals can be separated from the relative clause. It is ungrammatical to say (35) but completely fine to say (36).

(35) **ʔægær* mi-bin-i-ʃ [ke be-r-i]
if IMPFV-see-2SG-3SG.ACC that SBJV-go-2SG

(36) be ʔin fært mi-bin-i-ʃ [ke be-r-i]
to this condition IMPFV-see-2SG-3SG.ACC that SBJV-go-2SG

Once more, the same is true with causal clauses, as shown in (37) and (38).

(37) *tʃon did-i-ʃ [ke ræft-i]
 because see.PST-2SG-3SG.ACC that go.PST-2SG

(38) be ʔin dælil did-i-ʃ [ke ræft-i]
 to this reason see.PST-2SG-3SG.ACC that go.PST-2SG

So far, so good. We can see how Persian *ʔægær* and the PP *be ʔin ʃært* ‘to this condition’ differ in their syntactic manifestation. *ʔægær* ‘if’ and *ʃært* ‘condition’ are predicates that are internally merged in the specifier of a Linker Phrase. An overt preposition or a null one is higher in the specifier of the PP. This is illustrated in (39) and (40).

(39) [PP [P' Ø [DP [D' Ø [LP [ʔægær Ø]

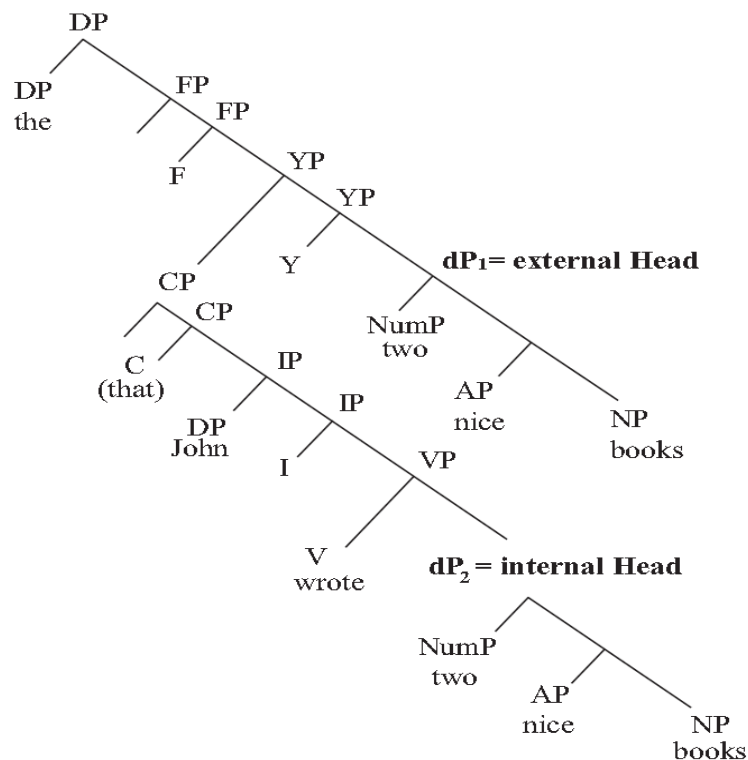
(40) [PP be [P' Ø [DP ʔin [D' Ø [LP [ʃært Ø]

Theoretical Prelude: The theoretical bases on which my analysis is built comes from Cinque’s (2020) unified account of relative clauses and den Dikken’s (2006) conception of subject-predicate relationships, an amalgam of these has just been proposed by Ilkhanipour and Sugawara (2024) for complex DPs in Persian.

[_{PP} [_{P'} P [_{DP} [_{D'} D [_{LP} [PREDICATEP] [_L L+R [_{RP} [_{CP} ...] [_R R [PREDICATEP]]]]]]]]]

Cinque (2020) shows that all types of relative clauses are derived from a single double-headed structure. Both raising and matching derivations are compatible with this structure.

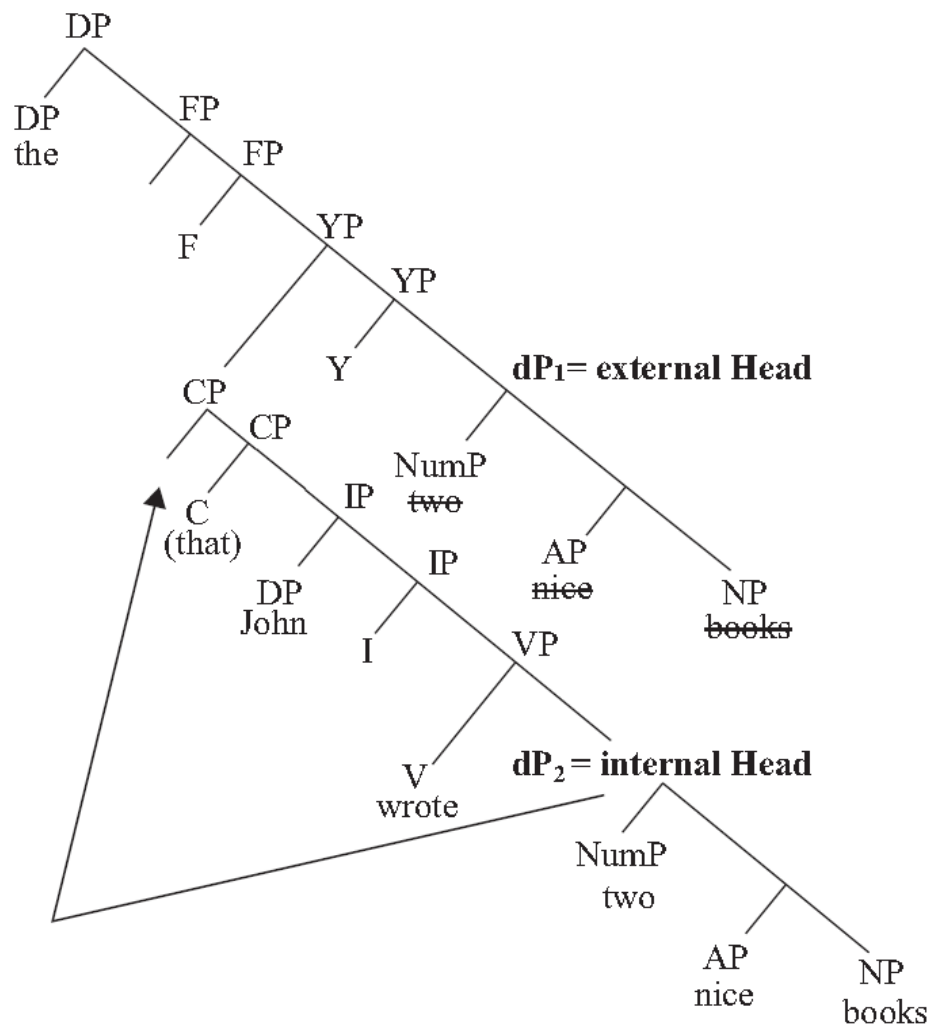
(41)



(Cinque 2020: 15, (17))

In the raising derivation, it is the internal Head that ends up being the overt Head; it raises to Spec,CP and licenses the deletion of the external Head, as illustrated in (42).

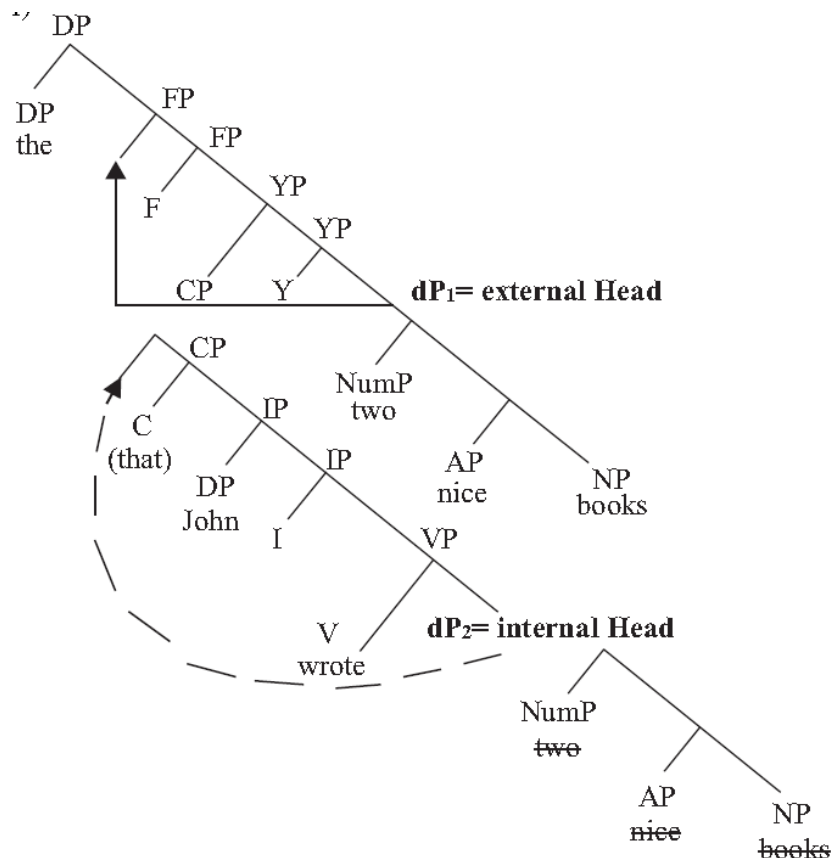
(42) Raising derivation:



(Cinque 2020: 17, (20))

In the matching derivation, on the other hand, the external Head raises to Spec,FP licensing the deletion of the internal one.

(43) Matching derivation:



(Cinque 2020: 18, (21))

Cinque does not discuss the nature of the two functional heads Y and F. It is, nonetheless, conspicuous that Y mediates between the internal and the external Head and that FP provides the necessary syntactic slot for the internal Merge of the external Head. In this regard, to have a more consistent and clearer ground in terms of theory, application and terminology, I resort to den Dikken's study of predication relationships.

In his analysis, den Dikken (2006) introduces two abstract functional heads: RELATOR (R) that mediates between a predicate and its subject in the base structure, and LINKER (L) that connects the raised predicate to the small clause involving the subject when the predicate inverts with the subject as in the predicate inversion constructions. I use these labels for the sake of uniformity and consistency. R and L can be occupied by different elements, e.g. copulas, or other functional categories.

So, with conditional clauses, we have the predicate phrase low in the structure which is occupied by *ǰægær* 'if' or *ǰært* 'condition'. Then by predicate inversion, the predicate moves to the specifier of the Linker Phrase. With *ǰægær* the preposition is not pronounced, with *ǰært*, it is.

(44) [PP [P' Ø [DP [D' Ø [LP [ǰægær Ø_[+cond]] [L' L+R [RP [CP ke ... be-r-i] [R' R [ǰægær Ø]]]]]]]]]

(45) [PP be [P' Ø [DP ǰin [D' Ø [LP [ǰært Ø_[+cond]] [L' L+R [RP [CP ke ... be-r-i] [R' R [ǰært Ø]]]]]]]]]

And a similar structure for causal adverbials will be as in (46) and (47).

(46) $[_{PP} [_{P'} \emptyset [_{DP} [_{D'} \emptyset [_{LP} [t_{\text{for}} \emptyset] [_{L'} L+R [_{RP} [_{CP} \text{ke} \dots \text{ræft-i}] [_{R'} R [t_{\text{for}} \emptyset]]]]]]]]]]]$

(47) $[_{PP} \text{be} [_{P'} \emptyset [_{DP} ?_{\text{in}} [_{D'} \emptyset [_{LP} [\text{dæli} \emptyset] [_{L'} L+R [_{RP} [_{CP} \text{ke} \dots \text{ræft-i}] [_{R'} R [\text{dæli} \emptyset]]]]]]]]]]]$

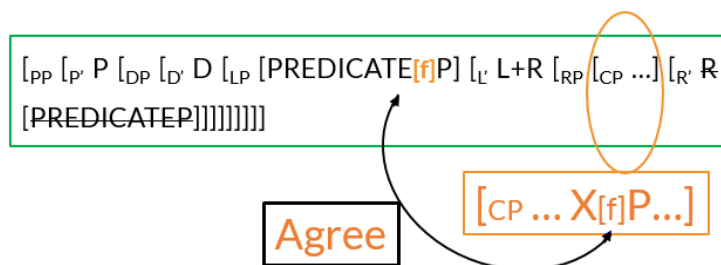
But why does R move to L? According to den Dikken, LP is an extended phase due to the raising of R to L and this allows for the visibility of the PREDICATE to RP-external probes (including L).

The Internal Syntax of Adverbial Clauses:

Now let's move on to the internal syntax of adverbial clauses. What is relativized? Or precisely, what is the internal Head and how is it related to the external Head?

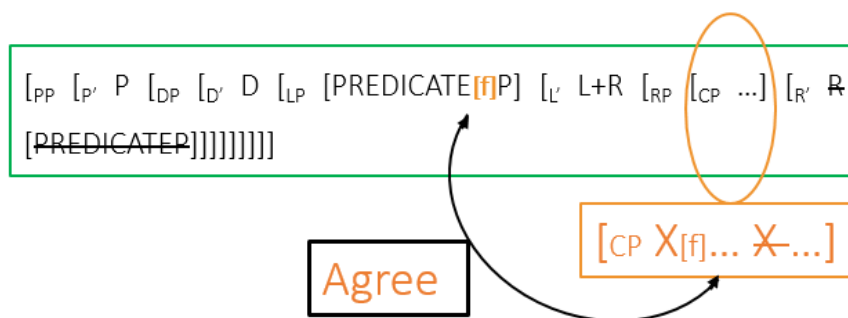
It has already been argued that the internal Head can be a high functional projections, as in Arsenijevic (2009) (see also Deal 2024). And happily, the cartographic literature is sufficiently rich to provide the necessary semantic classes we may need to think of (to be very brief, Rizzi and Cinque 2016 and references therein). So I take a high functional projection, for example some XP to be involved as the internal Head. This XP can be a conditional phrase, a reason phrase, a tense phrase, a force phrase, etc.

How are the two Heads related? Agree is the key. There is a partial matching between the two Heads and under the probe-goal relation, Agree is established between non-distinct features of the Predicate on one hand and the XP inside the embedded CP on the other hand.



I do not investigate the interpretability of the two matching features here; it is beyond the scope of this talk. However, I would like to point out that the interpretability and the valuation of the features as discussed in Pesetsky and Torrego (2007) should not be neglected.

Another issue to be considered here is the Phase Impenetrability Condition (PIC). If XP is in the interior of our embedded CP, then it is transferred to the CI system and the SM system upon the construal of the CP and hence becomes unavailable to further operations. How to deal with this? The answer is simple. X or the feature on X moves to the edge of the embedded CP due to some strong feature as proposed, for example, by Ilkhanipour (2016) and becomes accessible to higher heads.



A 'Temporal' Problem:

Apparently, the analysis is neat and responsive to our data. But there remains a problem and that's when we come to temporal clauses. Here's an example:

- (48) *did-æm-efun* *væqt-i* (ke) *ʔumæd-æn*
 see.PST-1SG-3PL.ACC time-INDF that come.PST-3PL
 'I saw them when they came.'

For Persian 'when' we have the word for time, *væqt*, plus the indefinite marker *-i*. This form, unlike English *when*, is not a *wh*-word, and is not used in embedded questions (cf. Hall & Caponigro 2010). Additionally, unlike Persian 'if' and 'because', it is not a weak nominal; it is +referential. Therefore, similar to *fært* 'condition' and *dælit* 'reason', we expect obligatory presence of the complementizer *ke*. This is not true. *Ke* is optional as can be seen in (49).

- (49) *væqt-i* (ke) *ʔumæd-æn*
 time-INDF that come.PST-3PL

Second, we expect the possible removal of the relative clause. This is not true. (50) is ungrammatical.

- (50) **did-æm-efun* *væqt-i*
 see.PST-1SG-3PL.ACC time-INDF

However, it is possible to separate *væqt-i* from the embedded CP, just like 'condition' and 'reason', so (51) is grammatical.

- (51) *væqt-i* *did-æm-efun* [ke *ʔumæd-æn*]
 time-INDF see.PST-1SG-3PL.ACC that come.PST-3PL

The Dual Status of Persian 'When': Persian 'when' behaves similar to Persian 'if' and 'because' with regard to the optionality of *ke* 'that' and the obligatory presence of the embedded CP. But, similar to the referential nominals *fært* 'condition' and *dælit* 'reason', it can appear separate from the embedded CP.

Note that when we replace *væqt-i* with the PP *dær ʔun væqt* 'in that time', the obligatory presence of *ke* and the possible removal of the relative clause come true as in (52) and (53).

(52) did-æm-eʃun (dær) ʔun væqt *(ke) ʔumæd-æn
 see.PST-1SG-3PL.ACC in that time that come.PST.3PL
 ‘I saw them at the time when they came.’

(53) did-æm-eʃun (dær) ʔun væqt
 see.PST-1SG-3PL.ACC in that time

So the problem is with this form *vaqti*. But why?

I have two tentative answers for now. First, *væqt-i* is being grammaticalized. By grammaticalization I mean a diachronic process of phonetic reduction and semantic bleaching. Regarding the phonetic form, there seems to be a reduction in the phonetic context of *væqt-i*. We have total omission of the preposition *dær* ‘in’ before *væqt-i* and the possible omission of *ke* ‘that’ after *væqt-i*.

As of semantic bleaching, *væqt-i* is losing its referential nominal nature and is approaching the functional grammatical status of Persian ‘if’ and ‘because’. Interestingly, with some prosodic change, *væqt-i* can be used meaning ‘because’, as in (54).

(54) væqt-i hæme mi-r-æn mæn-æm mi-r-æm
 time-INDF all IMPFV-go-3PL I-too IMPFV-go-1SG
 ‘I go because everybody goes.’

My second answer is related to the type of the relative clause. With *ʃært* ‘condition’ and *dælit* ‘reason’ the relative clause expresses the content of a specific condition or reason. This is not the case with *væqt* ‘time’. As we see in (55) to (57), we can use the quantifier *hær* ‘any’ before *væqt* ‘time’ but not with *ʃært* ‘condition’ and *dælit* ‘reason’.

(55) (dær) hær væqt(-i) ke ʔumæd did-æm-eʃ
 in any time-INDF that come.PST.3SG see.PST-1SG-3SG.ACC
 ‘I saw her/him at any time she/he came.’

(56) *be hær ʃært(-i) ke be-r-i mi-bin-i-ʃ
 to any condition that SBJV-go-2SG IMPFV-see-2SG-3SG.ACC
 (intended: the content of any condition be that you go)

(57) *be hær dælit(-i) ke ræft-e bud næ-did-æm-eʃ
 to any reason that go.PST-PP be.PST.3SG NEG-see.PST-1SG-3SG.ACC
 (intended: the content of any reason be that she/he had gone)

Concluding Remarks:

To conclude, I made an attempt to analyse adverbial clauses as involving predicate inversion via a Linker Phrase. I tried to apply to Persian data, the matching derivation of Cinque’s unified account of relative clauses where the internal Head is in a high functional projection and the external Head is the inverted predicate. These two Heads Agree in some matching feature in a probe-goal relation.

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